

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Operations | Financial Services

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, implementing, and operating enterprise security controls across complex, regulated environments. I bring deep expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), vulnerability management, Privileged Access Management (PAM), cloud identity security, and incident response. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and have direct experience aligning security operations to frameworks including ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials Plus. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I oversee the security of an estate of over 8,000 users, managing a broad portfolio of security platforms from CrowdStrike Falcon to Microsoft Sentinel, BeyondTrust PAM, and Microsoft Entra ID. I am now seeking a senior cybersecurity engineering role within a prestigious asset management or financial services firm where I can contribute to protecting critical data, meeting regulatory obligations, and continuously improving the organisation's security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) - expert level, 8,000+ endpoints; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection rule engineering, automation playbooks, alert triage
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure / Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Zero Trust architecture, cloud workload monitoring
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM) / MFA / SSO:** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication, Single Sign-On, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck; scan, prioritise, track remediation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle (detection, containment, eradication, recovery), MITRE ATT&CK threat mapping, threat hunting, forensic triage
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast email gateway, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM (Mobile Device Management / Mobile Application Management)
- **Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, IDS/IPS management, firewall policy governance
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR workflow automation
- **Regulatory Frameworks:** ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, GDPR, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Additional Tools:** Tanium, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Splunk/SPL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer | March 2025 - Present
- Oversee the security of an estate of 8,000+ endpoints, maintaining detection quality, tuning logic, and providing real-time endpoint telemetry for threat investigation.
- Manage Microsoft Sentinel SIEM in Azure, developing advanced KQL detection rules, onboarding log sources across Active Directory, cloud services, and endpoints, and operating SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage and response workflows.
 - Manage Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies for 8,000 users, applying Zero Trust principles to control access to cloud and on-premises applications.
 - Administer BeyondTrust PAM to enforce least-privilege access, control privileged accounts, and provide full audit trail for sensitive system access, supporting FCA-equivalent governance and data protection requirements.

- Lead vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS and Tenable.io, identifying and prioritising risks, and tracking remediation to closure with IT and infrastructure owners.
- Direct incident response activities following NIST 800-61 procedures, from detection and triage through containment, eradication, and post-incident review.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM for endpoint compliance, ensuring mobile and managed devices meet security policy requirements.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, maintaining anti-phishing, anti-malware, and data loss prevention controls.
- Coordinate penetration testing programmes with external providers, tracking remediation of all identified findings through to closure.
- Deliver security awareness training and communications to staff, driving measurable improvements in security behaviours.
- Maintain alignment with ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, and MITRE ATT&CK frameworks, contributing to governance and audit processes.

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity
 Managed daily security operations, including endpoint security, email security, and identity security platforms, investigating and escalating incidents in line with defined playbooks and procedures. *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Supported organisation-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender to 8,000 users, consolidating security visibility.
- Developed detection rules and threat hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, improving detection coverage and reducing mean time to identify threats.
- Managed vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck, generating prioritised remediation reports and supporting patch management governance.
- Configured and maintained Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA policies, supporting organisation-wide identity security improvements.
- Administered Check Point Harmony firewall and IDS/IPS rules, maintaining perimeter security and network access controls.
- Produced incident response reports and post-incident lessons-learned documentation in line with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK methodologies.
- Managed security certificate lifecycle across enterprise systems, ensuring timely renewal and correct deployment.

HUX Solutions Ltd (SaaS FinTech) - IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure
 Managed endpoint and network security controls within a regulated SaaS/FinTech environment, supporting a lean, agile IT security function with wide operational scope. *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Administered Active Directory, Group Policy, and identity management policies, enforcing access controls and supporting audit and compliance requirements.
- Conducted security monitoring, incident triage, and vulnerability assessments, implementing remediation actions to reduce organisational risk.
- Supported cloud migration projects, contributing security design requirements and carrying out security reviews of infrastructure changes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across 8,000+ endpoints, significantly improving endpoint visibility and materially reducing mean time to detect and respond to threats.
- Engineered a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SIEM with custom KQL detection rules and SOAR automation, reducing false positive volumes and enabling faster, evidence-based incident response.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM organisation-wide, enforcing least-privilege principles and delivering a full, auditable trail of privileged account activity to support governance and compliance requirements.
- Led deployment of the full Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) to 8,000 users, consolidating endpoint, identity, and cloud threat protection into a unified security platform.
- Established and managed a structured vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS and Tenable.io, achieving measurable reduction in critical and high-severity findings.
- Contributed to successful ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus certification cycles, demonstrating strong alignment to recognised security and compliance frameworks.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 80,000-90,000 | Hybrid (London or Edinburgh)